

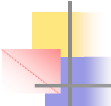
Word Formation Processes

Chapter 6



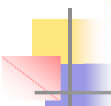
Introduction

- Spangler and his *electric suction* *sweeper*
- *Spangler*- *spanglering* – *spanglered* – *spanglerish* – *spanglarism*
- That didn't happen, but people still talk about '*hoovering*'
- **Neologism** → a new word, usage, or expression



Etymology

- The study of the origin of the word
- Etymology → comes from Latin but has Greek roots (*etymon* 'original from' + *logia* 'study of')
- Attitude towards new words entering a language
 - *Handbook* – *aviation* in the 19th century
 - *Computer* and *radio* in Arabic
- Ways in which a word can enter a language.



Types of Word Formation

1. Coinage
2. Borrowing
3. Compounding
4. Blending
5. Clipping
6. Backformation
7. Conversion
8. Acronyms
9. Derivation

Coinage

- Invention of totally new words
- Extension of a name of a product from a specific reference to a more general one
- e.g. *Kleenex*, *Xerox*, and *Kodak*
- **Eponyms**: words based on a name of a person or a place. E.g. sandwich, jeans, watt

Borrowing

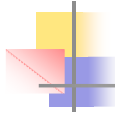
- Taking over of words from another language
- English borrowed a lot of Latin and French words
- *Leak* (Dutch) *Barbecue* (Spanish)
- *Piano* (Italian) *Sofa* (Arabic)
- *Croissant* (French) *Yogurt* (Turkish)
- Arabic also borrowed a lot of words from English, e.g. *television*, *radio*, *supermarket*
- Loan-translation or calque
 - A phrase that is introduced into a language through translation
 - Superman → الرجل الخارق
 - Skyscraper → ناطحة سحاب

Compounding

- Two or more words joined together to form a new word.
- Examples:
 - Home + work → homework (N)
 - Pick + pocket → pickpocket (N)
 - Low + paid → low-paid (Adj)

Note: The meaning of a compound is not always the sum of the meanings of its parts.

- Coconut oil → oil made from coconuts.
- Olive oil → oil made from olives.
- Baby oil → NOT made from babies



Blending

- Similar to compounds, but in blending *only parts* of the words are combined.
- Examples:
 - Motor + hotel → Motel
 - Breakfast + lunch → Brunch
 - Smoke + fog → smog
 - Teleprinter + exchange → telex



Clipping

- Shortening a word by deleting one or more syllables
- Examples:
 - Facsimile → fax
 - Hamburger → burger
 - Gasoline → gas
 - Advertisement → ad
 - Professor?
 - Doctor?

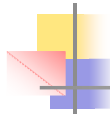
Backformation

- Creative *reduction* due to incorrect morphological analysis.
- Examples:
 - editor → edit
 - television → televise
 - babysitter → babysit

Note: backformation always involve reduction (changing the form of the word)

Conversion

- Assigning an already existing word to a new syntactic category.
- Examples:
 - **butter** (N) → V to butter the bread
 - **permit** (V) → N an entry permit
 - **empty** (A) → V to empty the litter-bin
 - **must** (V) → N doing the homework is a must
 - **Microwave** (N) → V



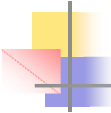
Acronyms

- Words derived from the initials of several words
- Examples:
 - National Aeronautics and Space Agency
→ NASA
 - United Nations International Children's Emergency Fund
→ UNICEF
 - United Nations Educational, Scientific, and Cultural Organization → UNESCO
 - Compact Disc → CD



Other examples of Acronyms:

- | | |
|----------|--------------------------------|
| a) Radar | a) Radio detecting and ranging |
| b) FYI | b) For Your Information |
| c) TGIF | c) Thanks God It's Friday |
| d) a.k.a | d) also known as |
| e) Html | e) Hypertext mark-up language |
| f) www | f) World wide web |
| g) btw | g) By the way |
| h) ATM | h) Automatic Teller Machine |
| i) FAQ | i) Frequently asked questions |



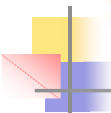
Derivation

- The most common word formation process.
- affixes
- Examples:

Happy → **un**happy, happi**ness**

Arrange → **re**arrange

- Prefixes vs. suffixes
- Infixes → inside the word
 - Tell them I've gone to Singa**bloody**pore!



Multiple Processes

- The **creation** of a **particular** word involves **more than one** process.
- Example: *Pro**blem**s with the project have snowballed*

Snow + ball → compound

Snowball (N) → (V) conversion

Multiple Processes

- Identify the processes involved in the creation of the following forms.
 - I just got a new car-phone
 - James wants to be a footballer
 - The negotiators blueprinted a new peace proposal

Complete the process and
Identify the type of word formation:

- | | | |
|-------------------------------------|------------------|-------------|
| 1. automatic | → Auto→ | clipping |
| 2. information, entertainment | → Infotainment → | blends |
| 3. modulator, demodulator | → Modem → | blends |
| 4. love, seat | → Loveseat → | compounding |
| 5. International, police | → Interpol → | blends |
| 6. A comb | → To comb → | conversion |
| 7. delicatessen | → Deli → | clipping |
| 8. Capt. Charles Cunningham Boycott | → Boycott → | eponym |

